

(Funk + Functional) = < 5k

You don't need bucket loads of money to have a computer system with all the cool peripherals in the market. Here are some handy accompaniments to your desktop that won't burn a hole in your pocket

TV on your PC

ADCOM SAA7130HL TV Tuner Card

Sure you can watch VCDs and listen to digital music on your PC. Now all that's missing is TV reception and your PC would become a total home entertainment system.

Well, here's something that should fill in the gaps just right. The ADCOM TV Tuner card is based on the CA8208 chip and is a 'tuner only' daughter card, which lets you tune-in to cable channels on your PC. Apart from the necessary port for connecting the TV antenna cable, it also provides you with Audio IN, Audio OUT, Video IN, and SVHS IN ports. The package includes a quick reference manual and the all-important remote control. You can also connect devices such as a camcorder and save your recorded videos on the PC. The card is fairly decent in terms of reception quality but its price is simply irresistible.

Contact: Advantage Computers Pvt Ltd (011-6485384)



Rs 2,400

Wheel deal!

Saitek R100 Steering Wheel

Given a chance you could take the fight to Michael Schumacher, but the only thing holding you back was the high prices of steering wheels!

Built to withstand and sustain severe jerks, the Saitek R100 fits neatly onto any desk with a rather heavy clamping mechanism, and is one of the cheapest steering wheels you can get. It comes with standard foot pedals that are strong enough to endure regular punishment. The buttons are easy to configure and their placement is fairly comfortable. The wheel requires no drivers and is detected without any trouble.

Contact: Origin Marketing (022-8835886)

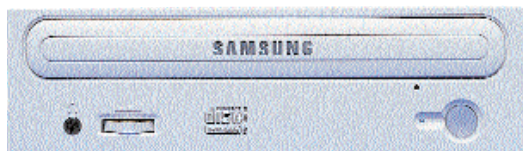


Rs 2,250

Burn baby burn!

Samsung SW-224 (24/10/40x)

With the launch of 32x and 40x CD-Writers, prices of the older 24x writers have simply nose dived! 24x writing speeds are fast enough and if you burn CDs only occasionally, you will never notice the difference between a 24x and a 32x writer.



The Samsung SW-224 24x CD-Writer is one of the fastest CD-Writers as far as writing assorted data on a CD-RW is concerned.

This drive comes with a standard 2 MB buffer and incorporates buffer under-run technology. Keeping the drive company is a bundled manual, IDE/audio cables, multi-speed CD-R and a 10x CD-RW disk. Also bundled is Nero v5.5.

Contact: Samsung India (011-6322517)

Rs 4,500

Floppy drive for James Bond

Frontech Genius GD1032 Flash Drive

Sick of that stupid old floppy drive? It's too cumbersome to use, has too little space, and most importantly, it is never reliable!

Here's an ultra portable 32 MB storage device that is cheap and easy to use. Using a hot-pluggable USB interface, the Frontech Genius GD1032 USB Flash Drive is probably the best replacement for your legacy floppy drive. The driver installation is as simple as it can get and the device shows up and works like any other drive in Windows Explorer, with a drive letter assigned to it. And best of all, it looks like something straight out of a James Bond movie!

Contact: Jupiter Infosys (022-2001211)



Rs 5,000